UNIVERSITY of STIRLING

CSCU9X5
HCI – UI – UX
Assignment 1 – Autumn 2026

THE BRIEF

You are required to **design** a web-based multimedia application and **build a prototype** version of it.

This prototype application must be built using **Bootstrap 5 / HTML5 / CSS / JavaScript** or **W3.CSS** technologies, with the support of libraries and frameworks.

1- Selecting a project topic & scope

The general topic of the application should be one of the following:

1. An interactive cultural site, for this you should pick a cultural experience which is not already available or develop an interactive experience which is significantly different from existing web resources.

2. A fanzine, i.e a site devoted to a specific cultural or artistic icon or music genre. Again, this site should be substantially different from existing web resources; i.e. *niche is better,*

3. A site devoted to a specific hobby, again one which is not already routinely available on the world wide web.

4. Another topic of your choice *providing that you have explicitly discussed and agreed the topic with the course lead by the end of week 3*. You will need an email trail to evidence that the project has been approved.

If you are unsure about the latter, please discuss this at the earliest opportunity with the course lead during the weekly tutorials or labs and before you have made any significant inroads in the project.

Treat the assignment as a "commercial" exercise: you have a deadline for producing your design and prototype (i.e. the assignment submission date) and you have a "budget" – it is worth 60% of your overall marks for the module.

Use these criteria to determine how long you should spend on the assignment and how much to produce. *(If at any stage you are unsure whether you need to do more (or less) work, then please ask).*

The focus of the report should be to demonstrate good design principles highlighted in the lectures.

Your website should have a minimum **of 5 different types of pages, each with different types of user interface and interactive design principles (i.e 1 Home Page & 4 different types of secondary pages)**

Requirements

There will be **THREE (3)** components to the submission for the assignment:

1. **Submission of a COMPULSORY AI statement coversheet**
   (…a template is included on the Canvas Assignment page)
2. ***A design report (worth 65% of the assignment mark)***
3. ***A prototype website / multimedia application (worth 35% of the assignment mark)***

1- **Note:** the submission of the AI statement coversheet is **COMPULSORY** and not optional.
It must be included as part of your submission.

2- **The report** should fully document your design for a multimedia application.

You should design a 'whole website', but you only have to build part of it (i.e. 1 home page + 4 secondary pages) to illustrate the concept design and demonstrate the interactive functionalities.

The report should contain: a description of the general concept including details of users, wireframe designs and justification of design choices, a plan for testing.

3- Using **Bootstrap 5 / HTML5 / CSS / JavaScrip technologies or W3.CSS**, you will build a prototype version of your designed website or multimedia application, that is, it is probably a partial implementation of your design which illustrates key elements.

Your prototype should clearly demonstrate the concept of your design, good use of multimedia, and technical competence with dynamic web development.

The sections below give more detail on the requirements for these components and the breakdown of marks.

1. **The use of AI statement coversheet**

Make sure to download the **AI statement coversheet** enclosed on the Canvas assignment page (file is: *coversheet_Template_Aug2025.docx*)

The submission of the AI statement coversheet is **COMPULSORY** and not optional and therefore **must** be included as part of your submission.

2. **THE REPORT**

The report should be in the form of a design document that fully documents your design for a multimedia application. Remember that you should design a whole product, but only have to build part of it to illustrate the idea. Your report should detail a consistent design process and *be specific to your development.* **Do not include generic** information about design and testing procedures.

10% of the marks are for the overall quality and structure of the report itself.

Note: *you should describe the design of the whole application, but build a prototype (restricted) version of it* (i.e. 1 home page + 4 secondary pages) to illustrate the concept design and demonstrate the interactive functionalities.

Word count / page limit: 3500 words +/- 20%. That's roughly 14 pages or less.

IMPORTANT NOTE:

The direct use of generative AI text or content in your report is NOT allowed.
Should you use AI generated text directly in your report, your assignment may be marked as a 'Fail' *(see also marking scheme enclosed)*

The use of bullet points in the report is not allowed. All sections should use a narrative descriptive style without bullet points.

- *You may however use AI generative AI text or content in your web prototype content (i.e. AI generated images or descriptions for example, but not the code).*

If you do, you must acknowledge this in the **COMPULSORY AI statement coversheet** (*coversheet_Template_Aug2025.docx*) **AND** also in section 5 of your report.

Hint: you must use the sections mentioned below as your report structure:

The report should contain the following:

- The **title** of your application, the file name of the main HTML file, and your student ID (but not your name).

Section 1 - Concept & target users
[10% of assignment marks]

- **A description of the general concept of the website / application:**
    - What is the website core concept?
    - What is the website purpose?
    - Why is this a good / strong design concept?
    - Who is it aimed at?

This should include an **overview** of who your target users are and **two specific distinct personas,** each with a scenario detailing a relevant **activity and context of use**.

Explain carefully why these personas are representative of your potential target users.

Section 2 – Design Development
[15% of assignment marks]

- Details of how you have developed the initial concept into a complete design
- Choices of User Interface and interaction features.
- Details of the design of your entire application, including wireframes and or mock-ups of major screen layouts, and a navigation (sitemap) map showing how these interconnect.

- Thoroughly **justify** your design choices.
- How does your design satisfy the needs of your personas and scenarios*?*
- An excellent submission will have substantial support for these decisions in terms of references to design guidelines, heuristics & UX principles.

Section 3 – Usability Testing & Evaluation
[15% of assignment marks]

- **Testing & Evaluation:** a plan and report of appropriate usability testing.

  In planning consider a wide range of user testing from inception to post-delivery feedback from customers.

  Note: you are not expected to carry out all testing: you are expected to design an evaluation plan rather than conduct an actual evaluation.

  However, you can use the labs to carry out some testing and evaluation activities.

  If your report includes details of evaluation activities, then clear evidence of these activities should be included in your report. Note that you do not have ethics approval to carry evaluation tasks outside of the CSCU9X5 class so all evaluation activities you undertake should only take place within the lab and tutorials hours of this course.

  'Evaluation tasks' that are carried out outside the CSCU9X5 lab and tutorials and without evidence will not be taken into consideration when marking this section.

  Report clearly which usability testing you have done (independently, or in groups), and its results. What can you conclude from these tests about your design? Are any changes advisable*?*
  (…You don't have to make those changes but describe how you would if given time)

Section 4 – Group activities & Co-design
[10**% of assignment marks]**

- A **brief** description of how you worked with other people during the tutorials & labs to broaden your perspective during this assessment and reflection on what you learned from that and how it improved your submission.

  If your report includes details of group activities, then clear evidence of these activities should be included in your report. Note that you do not have ethics approval to carry group activities outside of the CSCU9X5 class so all group activities you undertake should only take place within the lab and tutorials hours of this course.

- How did these activities change your ideas & design?

Section 5 – Prototype & Resources Description
[10% of assignment marks]

- A description of what your built prototype version contains, justifying why you have implemented the parts that you have to create the prototype version, and how this particular version of the overall system will help you evaluate your design.
- A **list of all sources** for any media and external CSS and JavaScript libraries or W3.css templates used in the prototype (i.e. web addresses, references scanned from etc), with a **short description** of what any external libraries are used for.
- Include a table of ALL THE FILES IN YOUR WEBSITE CODE SUBMISSION WITH A CLEAR BUT PRECISE EXPLANATION OF WHAT EACH FILES DOES
- SEE EXAMPLE BELOW:

FILE NAME	EXPLAIN WHAT THIS FILE DOES CONCISELY & CLEARLY
HomePage.html	
Page1.html	
…	
Page4.html	
myScriptFile.js	
myCSSFile.css	

Report presentation
[5% of assignment marks]

- Present a lean and coherent design report in your own words, with a good use of sketches, images or figures to illustrate your design

2. THE APPLICATION PROTOTYPE

Using **Bootstrap 5 / HTML5 / CSS / JavaScript** or **W3.CSS** technologies, you will build a prototype version of your designed multimedia application, that is, it is probably a partial implementation of your design which illustrates key elements.

Your prototype should clearly demonstrate the concept of your design, good use of multimedia, and technical competence with dynamic web development. An excellent submission will satisfy all of these criteria to a high level.

Your website should have a minimum **of 5 different types of pages, each with different types of user interface and interactive design principles (i.e 1 Home Page & 4 different types of secondary pages)**

The allocation of marks is:

- [**25% of assignment marks]**
  for good use of interactive modalities and multimedia elements, providing a high-quality prototype in terms of how well it demonstrates your concept

- [**10% of assignment marks]**
  for technical competence in web technologies

As a prototype, your application should:

- Show examples of all information presentation styles to be used in the final product.
- Include examples of all types of navigation and interaction to be employed.
- Clearly indicate when material is missing or will be different in the final system e.g. never have a clickable button that does nothing! At least have a text box describing what should happen.
- Use **relative URLs** to local content (images, web pages) where possible so that the application can be run on the **local file space** (and not via a web server).

The emphasis in the prototype is NOT on the quality of media you have available, but on the sensible integration of different media (text, graphics, animation etc) and the usability of the system (e.g. is it easily navigable).

So *do not spend hours on producing original media*.

Where you would use different media in the final product, this should be indicated in the prototype (e.g. a still image in place of a video, with some text indicating this).

You may be able to find suitable media on the Web, or in books, magazines etc, but beware of copyright issues.

Be sure to reference your sources in your report.

You are encouraged to make use of third party CSS frameworks and JavaScript libraries (Bootstrap, W3.CSS, W3.CSS templates etc), but how you make use of them must be clearly documented in your report.

Remember to supply the library files with your submission (unless they are linked to via a web address).

Assignment submission

You will need to submit your work on Canvas as a single zip file.

This zip file you should be a zipped folder.

Name the zip file: YYYYYYY.zip (replacing the Ys with your 7-digit student id number)

Inside the folder there should be:

1. The COMPULSORY AI statement coversheet

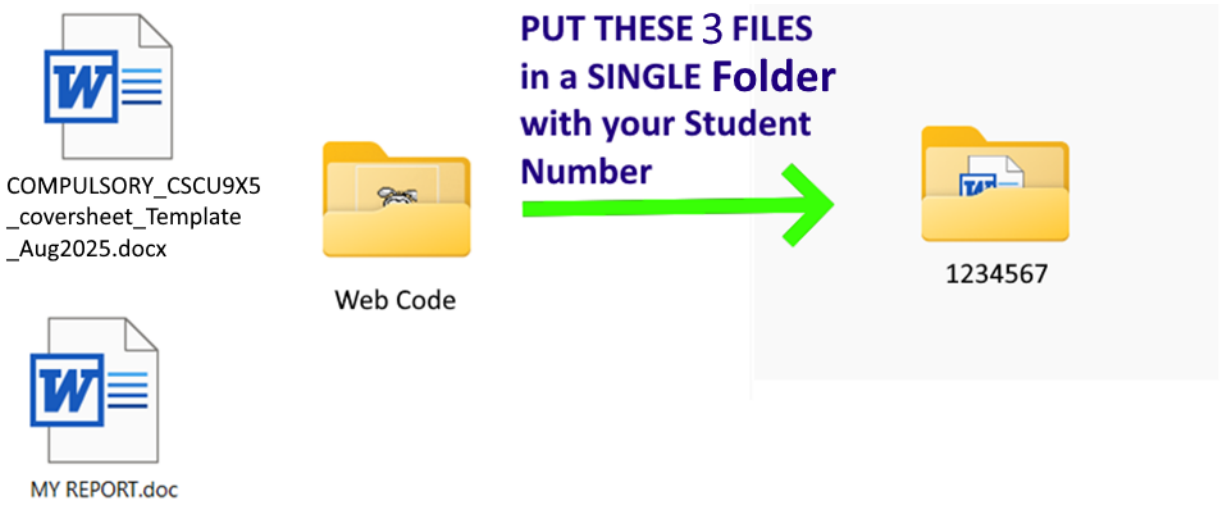
2. Your web design report

3. A folder containing your website code:

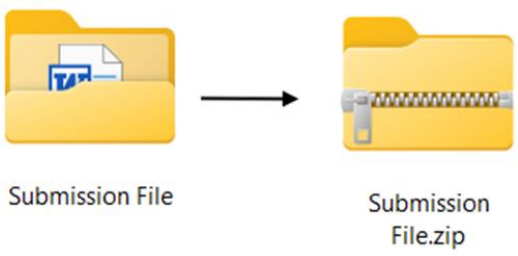
IMPORTANT:

- your website code should include all that is needed to launch your website without the need for any additional external resources (unless retrieved from the web, e.g. YouTube).
- All that should be needed to launch your website should be to click on your HomePage.html file and open it in a browser.
- You should test your website with different browsers and a different computer then where the code was written on to make sure your website code is portable.
- If your website does not run from the homepage, your project may be failed.

What should be in the Submission file?



…& Zip & SUBMIT!

Name the zip file: YYYYYYY.zip (replacing the Ys with your 7-digit student id number) and submit!	

How will this assignment be marked?

Here is a summary of what you need to achieve to gain a grade in the major grade bands:

Grade	Requirement
Fail	• Project concept approval form not submitted & concept not approved, concept not suitable for the assignment with the student having failed to take the opportunity to get the concept approved via the concept approval form or other means (e.g. discussion with course lead / tutor during labs, tutorials or via email). • Project submission guidelines not followed • Project submitted using other technologies then the ones explicitly specified in the brief (i.e. **Bootstrap 5 / HTML5 / CSS / JavaScript** or **W3.CSS** technologies) • Website application is technically trivial (barely modified template, text and images with no interactive features) • Website application has been reproduced from elsewhere without acknowledgement and modification • File table (section 5) description not submitted or inadequate • Website application code has been shared with other students for this exact assignment • Report is very weak and or does not match the application submitted • Report clearly written using generative AI in part or ion whole • Part of the report is fabricated (e.g. mention of usability evaluation with participants with no evidence to support that these evaluation were actually conducted in practice • Report structure and content do not follow the assignment guidance. • No design report submitted
3rd	• Project concept approval form not submitted & concept not approved, concept inadequate for the assignment e.g. (similar website exist, design copied from elsewhere) with the student having failed to take the opportunity to get the concept approved via the concept approval form or other means (e.g. discussion with course lead/ tutor during labs, tutorials or via email). • Project submission guidelines not adequately followed • Website application is simplistic but with some evidence of weak - yet personal – design • File table (section 5) description is insufficient • Report is weak with some miss-matches compared to the application submitted • Some sections of report are either missing or under-developed • No clear evidence of design process • Report structure and content does not always follow the assignment guidance.
2:2	• Project concept approval form submitted & concept approved • Website application is good, with some evidence of personal design • File table (section 5) description is sufficient • Report is adequate but may lack depth in justifications or explanations • Lack justification of design process • Report is adequate but could be improved with additional clarity or coherence

2:1	• Project concept approval form submitted & concept approved • Website application is very good with some evidence of personal design and inclusion of engaging interactive features • File table (section 5) description is good • Report is very good and includes good justifications and explanations • Good & realistic proposed evaluation • Very good justification of design process, based on course UX principles • Report is well structured, clear and coherent
1st	• Project concept approval form submitted & concept approved • Excellent concept development and design development • Excellent proposed evaluation; or alternatively, some evidence of preliminary evaluation having taken place • Evidence of group activities having influenced the design, testing or evaluation of the website • The website application is excellent with some strong evidence of personal design and inclusion of a range of engaging interactive features • File table (section 5) description is very good • Report is excellent and includes excellent justifications and explanations throughout • Excellent justification of design process, based on course UX principles • Report presentation is excellent overall, well structured, clear and coherent throughout

Academic Integrity

Work which is submitted for assessment must be your own work. Academic misconduct may include plagiarism, which means presenting the work of others as though it were your own.
The University takes a very serious view of plagiarism, and the penalties can be severe (ranging from a reduced grade in the assessment, through a fail grade for the module, to expulsion from the University for more serious or repeated offences). Specific guidance in relation to Computing Science assignments may be found in the Computing Science Student Handbook.
We check submissions carefully for evidence of plagiarism, and pursue those cases we find.
All students should note that the University has an agreed policy setting out procedures and penalties for dealing with academic misconduct.

This policy can be found on the University's portal

https://www.stir.ac.uk/media/stirling/services/academic-registry/documents/academic-integrity-policy.pdf

The policy also gives guidance on proper and adequate acknowledgement of source material, but if students are in any doubt at all about the nature of plagiarism, or the means by which to avoid it, students are strongly advised to consult their tutor. Students should clearly understand that it is their responsibility to be sure they understand these matters. Ignorance is not accepted as a defence for plagiarism.

Statement on use of Generative AI tools

The ethical and intentional use of Generative Artificial Intelligence Tools (AI) is permitted in this assignment under the following conditions.

1- *You may use generative AI to generate text content within your website*
2- *You may use generative AI to generate media content within your website (e.g. images, sound, music, videos, animations)*

You must NOT use generative AI to write any part of your design report.

Whenever AI tools are used you must:

- **Acknowledge** in the report how you have used AI in your website *(…in section 5)*
- **State clearly what content within your website has been created in part or in whole *(…and confirm which)* with generative AI** *(…in section 5)*
- **Cite** as a source, any AI tool used in completing your assignment *(…in section 5)*

Using AI without citation or against assessment guidelines falls within the definition of plagiarism or cheating, depending on the circumstances, under the current **Academic Integrity Policy**, and will be treated accordingly.

Making false or misleading statements as to the extent, and how AI was used, is also an example of "dishonest practice" under the policy.

Use of AI statement coversheet

Make sure to download the **COMPULSORY AI statement coversheet** enclosed on the Canvas assignment page (file is: *coversheet_Template_Aug2025.docx*)

The submission of the AI statement coversheet is **COMPULSORY** and not optional and therefore **must** be included as part of your submission *(See also the submission instructions detailed above).*

Extensions

Students who can show good cause may be permitted extensions to the assignment deadline.

See:

https://www.stir.ac.uk/about/professional-services/student-academic-and-corporate-services/academic-registry/academic-policy-and-practice/quality-handbook/assessment-policy-and-procedure/

…for details of the policy on Extensions for Coursework.

Students must request an extension via Canvas (Extension Request, in the left-hand navigation). Supply enough detail that your request may be judged by the module coordinator. Extensions will be granted for exceptional reasons only, and should be submitted in advance of the coursework

deadline.
Students with an ARUAA may also request an extension on the basis of their ARUAA, but similarly must give a rationale for the particular need for this extension.

Late submission

Without an agreed extension, the assignment will be accepted up to seven days after the hand-in deadline (or expiry of any agreed extension) but the grade will be lowered by 3 marks (out of 100) per day or part thereof.

After seven days the work will be deemed a non-submission and you will receive 0 marks for this assignment. *Since this assessment is worth 60% of the module grade, this will effectively mean a fail grade for the module.*

END OF ASSIGNEMENT DESCRIPTION